Tara Nelson-Thyroid Health Naturally

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18/9/2025

To Whom It May Concern,

Re: Briony Ferguson– Medical Advice Regarding Environmental Chemical Exposure

I am writing in my professional capacity as a qualified Naturopath regarding my patient, **Briony Ferguson**, who has been diagnosed with **autoimmune Graves' disease**, a serious thyroid disorder in which the immune system attacks the thyroid gland, leading to overproduction of thyroid hormones.

Patients with autoimmune conditions, including Graves' disease, are **highly sensitive to environmental triggers**. Exposure to **pesticides, herbicides, and volatile organic compounds (VOCs)** from paints and solvents can **exacerbate autoimmune activity**, disrupt thyroid function, and worsen symptoms such as palpitations, anxiety, insomnia, and weight loss.

Health Risks of Proposed Chemical Use

1. **Pesticides & Herbicides (e.g., glyphosate, organophosphates)**
   - Known endocrine disruptors that interfere with thyroid hormone regulation and immune balance【1】.
   - Glyphosate has been associated with increased oxidative stress and autoimmune risk【2】.
2. **Paints, Varnishes & Solvents**
   - Emit VOCs (benzene, toluene, formaldehyde) that can trigger immune dysregulation, respiratory irritation, and thyroid disruption【3】【4】.

- Indoor VOC exposure is linked to higher rates of autoimmune thyroid disease【5】.

Medical Recommendation

In light of this, I strongly recommend that:

- **No pesticides or herbicides** be sprayed around the property during the tenancy.
- **Postpone interior and exterior painting** until the property is vacant.

These measures are not only medically necessary but also in line with the **duty of care under tenancy and health regulations** to provide a safe living environment.

I appreciate your understanding and cooperation in safeguarding my patient's health. Should you require further clarification, please do not hesitate to contact me.

Sincerely,

Tara Nelson
Naturopath | BNat |

References

1. Mnif W, et al. "Endocrine disrupting chemicals and human health." *Int J Environ Res Public Health.* 2011.
2. Thongprakaisang S, et al. "Glyphosate induces human breast cancer cells growth via estrogen receptors." *Food Chem Toxicol.* 2013.
3. Rumchev K, et al. "Indoor air pollution from VOCs and asthma in children." *Thorax.* 2004.
4. U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA). "Volatile Organic Compounds' Impact on Indoor Air Quality." EPA, 2022.
5. Fang Y, et al. "Association between VOC exposure and autoimmune thyroid disease." *Sci Total Environ.* 2021.

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